

know they always have more to learn, and they look to a supportive network to teach them new things and encourage them along the way.

There are four key relationships you need to incorporate into your life as you work your way up to and beyond the millionaire mark. First, you need a *coach*. This is someone who stands on the sidelines and challenges you to keep making progress. When you fall, this is the voice you hear yelling at you to get up. When you're running the wrong way, this is the one who is screaming to get your attention. This is the person who tells it like it is, who won't blow smoke just to make you feel better if you're being stupid. I've had athletic, business, and financial coaches my entire life, and these men and women have played a huge role in the man I've become. Find someone who does the same for you.

Second, you need a *mentor*. Our study revealed that 86% of millionaires actively get advice from mentors. This is someone who has done what you want to do. They're on the same journey, but they're a few miles ahead of you. They've seen the dangers and overcome the obstacles you haven't reached yet, and they're happy to share what they've learned. Of course, books and seminars are great ways to learn, but nothing beats a wise mentor taking you by the hand and showing you how to do what they've already accomplished for themselves. And no, I'm not talking about a boring, forced, semi-uncomfortable weekly breakfast meeting. If that works for you, great. But I personally prefer to keep things more casual. The mentors who have meant the most to me are the ones who seem to pop in on my life every now and then, dropping wisdom in the moment. Don't overthink your mentor strategy. Just be on the lookout for someone who can speak into your life and take them out for coffee once every few months. Save up some questions over time so you can have a deep, meaningful conversation when you meet. Ask them their stories, learn what makes them tick. Ask them to tell you their biggest failures and what they learned from them. Keep things informal and learn as much as you can.

Third, you need a *cheerleader*. This is someone who believes in you and is there to encourage you no matter what. All the years I spent on the football field made me realize the value of having cheering fans on the sidelines. Sure, I had coaches yelling at me, giving me instructions, calling plays, and trying to keep my head in the game, but sometimes I didn't need marching orders; I just needed encouragement. I needed someone to call out